

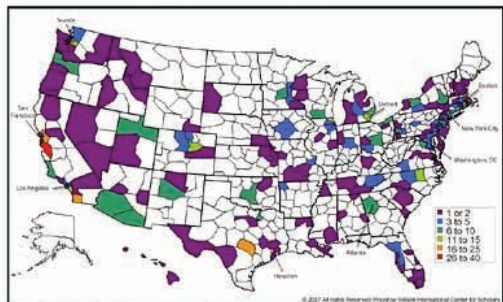
Countries

United States of America

The United States is a hotbed of nanotechnology activity. The US government has joined forces with industry and academia to build expensive facilities and labs around the country. The National Nanotechnology Initiative (NNI) is a US government program to coordinate nanotechnology efforts in the various agencies. The National Science Board, an advisory body of the National Science Foundation (NSF), also funds the NNIN – the National Nanotechnology Infrastructure Network- a joint venture combining the resources of 13 university programs. These schools support research and education in nano-scale science, engineering, and technology and aim to eventually make up an integrated, nationwide system of user facilities.

There are at least 11 US government agencies or departments with research-and-development budgets for nanotechnology. On one hand you have NASA, which is working on using nanomaterials to reduce the weight of spacecraft, while on the other hand the Environmental Protection Agency is funding studies into the use of nanomaterials to clean up pollution – as well as studies to evaluate the potential hazards of nanomaterials themselves. There is money out there in US for people looking for a grant for their next nano-product. The federal research money comes in the form of grants given by individual government departments and agencies in line with their individual missions. It doesn't just stop at financial grants; there are special programs just to seed commercial activities in nano to stimulate economic growth. These programs push small-business collaboration with universities and other research groups.

Even individual states in US are devoting resources to bring its citizens a step closer to the future that nanotechnology promises. One of the big players is the state of New York which has committed over \$1.4 billion to establish five Centers of Excellence in nanoelectronics, photonics, bioinformatics, information technology,



Region-wise Nanotech centers distribution.